Conversation 2

Starts, Ends, and Errors

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1. Pre-Sequences

Pre-sequences are turns or adjacency pairs that lead up to a particular (more important) adjacency pair

- For example, a question-answer pair which occurs before an invitation
  - Leads up to a particular 'core' adjacency pair
- Pre-invitation, pre-question, pre-request, and pre-announcements are most common

PRE-INVITATION (=QUESTION)	a	Are you doing anything on Friday?
ANSWER	b	No, why?
PRE-INVITATION (=STATEMENT)	a	We're all going to the pub.
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT	b	That sounds nice.
INVITATION	a	Would you like to come along?
ACCEPTANCE	b	That sounds lovely.

a Are you doing anything on Friday?
b No, why?
a I just wondered. Popular people usually have plans on Fridays.

a Are you doing anything on Friday?
b Yes, I'm off to Paris for the weekend.
a Lucky you!

a Are you doing anything on Friday?
b No, why?
a Oh good, we're looking for someone to babysit on Friday night.
b Ah, I thought you meant Friday *daytime*.

2. Greetings

What turns are used at the opening of a conversation?

- What turns characterize openings remotely and in person?
- How do these differ in structure and layout?

Remotely (eg telephone calls):

- Summons/answer pair
- Identification/recognition pair
- Greetings
- Personal enquiry (question/answer pair)
- Initiation of topic

c *[Causes phone to ring at R's location]*
r Hello?
c Hi, it's Fraser!
r Oh, hi Fraser!
c How're things?
r Good, you?
c Yeah, fine, thanks. Listen, I was wondering if…

In person, many are similar as remotely, but lots are are optional depending on the context, and also with contextual additions in any structure:

- Self/other-oriented comments
- Neutral contextual comments – e.g. about the weather, journey, etc
- Offers – e.g. drinks

3. Closings

What turns characterize the close of a conversation?

- How do conversations end?
- What moves indicate a conversation is about to end (pre-closings)?
- What affects the speed of a closing?

A conversation closes with:

- Closing signals (*Okay, All right, So, Right, Good, Well*)
- Terminal elements (*Bye, then, Bye, See you*)

Pre-closings are the build-up to a conversation ending (often several moves):

- Future arrangements
- Broad indication of future meeting
- C/R makes excuses
- Onus shifted to C
- Onus shifted to R
- Reason for call
- Solicitudes
- Back references
- Thanking

Standard closings are four turns, disrupted by:

- Misplacement markers (*Oh, by the way*)
- Foreshortened closing (*Right, okay, bye then*)
- Extended closing (many closing signals, reluctance to start terminal elements)

4. Errors

Speakers can make mistakes and hearers can mishear:

Speakers

- Hesitation phenomena (repetition, pauses, fillers, place-finders, changes)
- Speech errors (slips of the tongue, mispronunciation, malapropisms)
- Memory problem
- Interaction errors (overlaps, misplacement markers)
- Wrong information
- Insufficient information/ambiguity

Hearers

- Speaker is unclear
- Background noise
- Hearer has hearing problem
- Hearer is a child, has medical issues, uncertain grasp of language
- Hearer mistakes the illocution
- Hearer has wrong world-knowledge

5. Repairs

A repair resolves a communication problem (eg because of an error) by making a correction at a TRP:

- The speaker can notice their own error, or the hearer can
  - *Self-initiated or other-initiated*
- The speaker can correct their own error, or the hearer can
  - *Self-repair or other-repair*
- Obvious politeness preference for self-repair

Where can a repair happen:

Opportunity 1

self-initiated self-repair during the same turn as the error

Opportunity 2

self initiates repair at TRP and self-repairs

Opportunity 3

self initiates repair at TRP and other-repairs

Opportunity 4

other initiates repair at TRP and self-repairs

Opportunity 5

other initiates repair at TRP and other-repairs

a I saw him arrive on Sunday, and –
wait, no, I mean *Saturday* – and he…

a I've got to get my, whatchamacallit, prescription sorted…

a If we do it that way, people will be able to opt-out of being phoned. I mean *in*.

a The trackpad on my laptop is making my wrist hurt, I need to go buy a…
um, a thingy, you know…
b A mouse?
a Yeah, I need to get a mouse.

a Let's go into town, I've got book vouchers for Waterman's to use.
b For… "Waterman's"?
a Oh, I mean *Waterstones*.

a Let's go into town, I've got book vouchers for Waterman's to use.
b Do you mean *Waterstones*?
a Oh, yeah.

a Let's go into town, I've got book vouchers for Waterman's to use.
b Waterstones, yeah, let's go there.

a So what do you think about the news?
b What news?
a The whole election thing!
b Oh that, yeah, that's terrible…

a Then we went to the capital, Toronto.
b Isn't Ottawa the capital?
a Oh, yes, of course.

a Then we went to the capital, Toronto.
b I *think* Ottawa might be the capital?
a Ah, I think you're right, yes.

a Then we went to the capital, Toronto.
b You mean Ottawa, you fuckwit.
a Who even cares, Toronto's the big one with all the stuff.

a So I'll see you Friday.
b No, tomorrow.
a Tomorrow, yeah.

a So I'll see you Friday.
b No, tomorrow.
a Don't think so, definitely Friday, because tomorrow you said you're at that thing.